



**1169**

## Egyptian ruler

Islamic warrior Saladin became the first sultan, or ruler, of Egypt and Syria, establishing the Ayyubid Dynasty. His rule spread across parts of Arabia and Africa and he played an important role in wars in the Holy Land – sacred to Jews, Christians, and Muslims.

## Also on this day

### 1859 French doctor Edmond Lescarbault

believed he'd spotted a new planet and named it Vulcan. It's now thought he saw an asteroid.

### 1897 The first Māori lawyer Āpirana Turupa

Ngata took his position at the Supreme Court in Auckland, New Zealand.

### 1979 A peace treaty between Egypt and

Israel was finalized with a televised handshake between the leaders of the two countries in Washington, DC, USA.

## Born this day

**1931 Leonard Nimoy**, US actor. He was best known for playing the sharp-eared Spock in the long-running science-fiction series *Star Trek*.

March

26

2012

## Skateboarding stunt

A remarkable skateboarding feat, the 1080, was achieved for the first time by 12-year-old Tom Schaar in California, USA. The US skateboarder used a mega ramp to perform three full rotations in the air.



1927

## Non-stop racing

The Italian car race Mille Miglia, meaning "Thousand Miles", was held for the first time. The competing drivers sped off in their sports cars from the city of Brescia at speeds of up to 77 kph (48 mph). The winner returned to Brescia in just over 21 hours.

